Codes of Nomenclature

ICN has formulated a set of rules and recommendations dealing with the botanical name of plants. International Botanical Congress is held at different places every six years. Proposals for nomenclatural changes and changes in rules are discussed and implemented. Changes are published in their website.

18th International Botanical Congress held in 2011at Melbourne, Australia made the following major changes.

1. The code now permits electronic publication of names of new taxa.
2. Latin diagnosis or description is not mandatory and permits the use of English or Latin for the publication of a new name (Art-39).
3. "One fungus, one name" and "one fossil one name" are important changes, the concept of anamorph and teleomorph (for fungi) and morphotaxa (for fossils) have been eliminated. (Previously, sexual and asexual stages of the fungus/ fossils were provided with different names).

Anamorph – Asexual reproductive stage of fungus.

Teleomorph – Sexual reproductive stage of fungus.

4. As an experiment with "registration of names" new fungal descriptions require the use of an identifier from a "recognized repository". There are two recognized repositories **Index fungorum** and **Myco Bank**.

19th International Botanical Congress was held in Shenzhen in China in 2017. Changes accepted by International Botanical Congress are yet to be published.

Vernacular names (Common names)

Vernacular names are known as **common names.** They are very often descriptive and poetic references to plants. Common name refer to more than one plant or many plants may have same common name. These names are regional or local and are not universal. Example: *Albizia amara* . L belongs to *Mimosaceae* is called as *Usilai* in South Tamilnadu and *Thurinji* in North Tamilnadu.

Activity

Write common name and scientific name of 10 different plants around your home.

Scientific Names / Botanical Names

Each and every taxon as per the ICN (species, genus, family etc) can have only one correct scientific name. Scientific name of a species is always a binomial. These names are universally applied. Example: *Oryza sativa L.* is the scientific name of paddy.

Polynomial

Polynomial is a descriptive phrase of a plant. Example: *Ranunculus calycibus retroflexis pedunculis falcatis caule erecto folius compositis.* It means butter cup with reflexed sepals, curved flower stalks, erect stem and compound leaves. Polynomial system of naming a plant is replaced by a binomial system by Linnaeus.

Binomial

Binomial nomenclature was first introduced by **Gaspard Bauhin** and it was implemented by **Carolus Linnaeus**. Scientific name of a species consists of two words and according to binomial nomenclature, the first one is called **genus name** and second one is **specific epithet.** Example: *Mangifera indica*. *Mangifera* is a genus name and *indica* is specific epithet. This system is in vogue even now.

Author citation

This refers to valid name of the taxa accompanied by the author's name who published the name validly. Example: *Solanum nigrum* L. There are two types of author citation.

Single author: When a single author proposed a valid name, the name of the author alone

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